

The Invisible Ecosystem

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Sudhin Mathur has spent the smartphone era helping build one of India's biggest tech ecosystems. As COO of Xiaomi India, he argues the next chapter isn't about more devices – it's about devices that disappear into everyday life. He talks scale, ecosystems, and why AI is a capability, not a strategy.

How has tech evolved over the past 25 years?

Over the past 25 years, technology has gone from being something we used to something we live inside. We've moved from pagers and feature phones to intelligent ecosystems where smartphones, wearables, homes, and even vehicles work seamlessly together. Connectivity evolved from 2G to 5G, but the bigger shift is that technology became deeply personal, intuitive, and almost invisible.

At Xiaomi, this evolution has shaped how we think about innovation, not as standalone devices, but as connected experiences integrated across everyday life. From smartphones and AIoT to smart homes and mobility, the focus is increasingly on building ecosystems rather than individual products.

What once felt futuristic is now part of everyday life. The best technology today is the kind you stop noticing. AI and connected ecosystems are no longer just responding to commands, but quietly adapting around how we live, work, and move through the day, making experiences more intuitive and seamless.

What's equally important is accessibility. Innovation is no longer limited to a few urban pockets. Millions across India now experience connected technology as part of everyday life.

How is tech going to transform our lives?

The next 25 years will not just change technology, but human expectations.

We are moving toward a world where devices, homes, vehicles, and infrastructure work together far more intelligently and intuitively than they do today. The biggest shift will not be more technology, but technology becoming almost invisible.

At Xiaomi, we increasingly see innovation not as standalone devices, but as connected experiences built around everyday life. The best technology is the kind you stop noticing. It quietly adapts around you.

What excites me most is technology's ability to solve problems at scale while staying deeply human-centred.



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AI will undoubtedly shape the way we interact with technology, but what matters more is how thoughtfully it is applied. The misconception is treating AI as the strategy itself, when in reality, it is a capability that needs a clear purpose. The real balance will be in ensuring these advancements continue to amplify human thinking and judgment, not replace it.

The future will belong to connected ecosystems that feel seamless, intuitive, and deeply integrated into everyday life.

On Digit completing 25 years

Congratulations to the team at Digit on completing 25 years. Technology has evolved rapidly over this period, and informed consumers have played a huge role in accelerating that shift. For brands like Xiaomi, building at scale has only been possible because awareness and understanding around technology have grown so significantly over the years.

Publications like Digit have contributed meaningfully to that evolution by making technology more understandable, credible, and relevant for consumers. As technology becomes more integrated into everyday life, the conversation will increasingly move beyond standalone devices to connected experiences and ecosystems. Wishing the team continued success for the years ahead. 